RPG Music Essentials FREE
User Guide v1.0

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Track List

- Battle Theme – Easy Pickins
- Event Them e– Corrupt Ether
- Exploration Theme – Somber Secrets
- Location Theme – Forest of the Ancients
- Overworld Theme – Into the Unknown

File Naming Conventions

Browsing through the files included in RPG Music Essentials, you'll quickly notice that all the files are named in a consistent, intentional format. The format follows the convention shown below:

***Genre_TrackTitle*_Final_FIRST/LOOP**

Genre denotes the genre or style of music for a given track. This is a good indicator of the use case or situation where I feel the track will fit the best. Of course, this is a guideline only – please feel free to use the music as you see fit!

TrackTitle is the name of the track that I've chosen. This just helps me tell them apart from each other when looking at them in the folder view.

Final is just an indicator that I have used to mark each track as a finished, polished and professional piece of audio. This can be ignored by the user.

FIRST/LOOP denotes whether the file should be looped continuously or played only the first time this particular piece of music is used in a given instance of the game. EVERY track included has a "_LOOP" file, but NOT EVERY track included has a "_FIRST" file. There are two reasons that "_FIRST" variations of the track are included:

- The track has an intro that is meant to only play the first time the track plays. Battle tracks typically have this to signify the start of combat.
- Starting the track using only the "_LOOP" would be slightly jarring to the listener

If a file has both a "_FIRST" and "_LOOP" variant, it is recommended that when implemented in the game engine the "_FIRST" variant is played first just once. The "_LOOP" track should then be looped repeatedly after that.

The "_FIRST" variant is included purely for your convenience! If you'd rather just used the "_LOOP" tracks for ease of implementation, that's totally cool too!

Let's walk through an example of the naming convention:

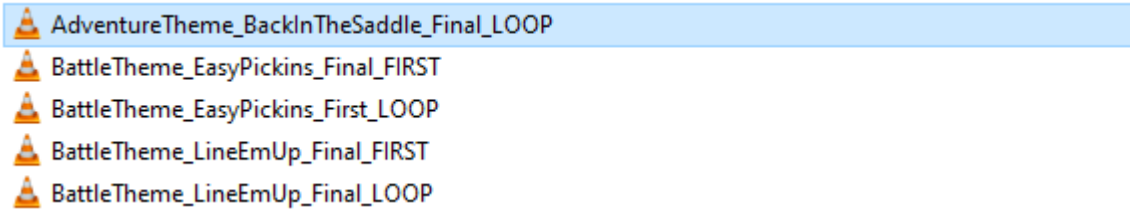

Figure 1 - Naming Convention Example

The track highlighted above in Figure 1 is called "AdventureTheme_BackInTheSaddle_Final_LOOP". Following the naming convention outlined above, we now know that:

- This is a track in the "adventure" genre. It may be good for exploring the wilderness between combat, riding in an airship, or cruising around on the world map.
- The name of the track is "Back in the Saddle".
- It is a LOOP. I can play this on repeat and it will have a seamless transition from beginning to end.

Genres and Uses

As mentioned earlier, the genres hinted to in the names of the files is an indication of how the track might be used in an RPG. Of course, this is totally subjective, and the user should feel free to experiment!

Adventure – Light and Energetic. Tracks that inspire a sense of endless possibility.

Battle – Fast paced and driving**.** Tracks that would work well for combat or battles.

Boss – Similar to **Battle** tracks above but meant for even more bigger and badder baddies.

Emotional – Slow, quiet, and sentimental. Tracks that would work well for more emotional dialogue, or for character themes.

Event – Distinct and bold. Tracks that would work well for when and special events occur in the story.

Exploration – Inquisitive and mysterious. Good for puzzle solving and exploring the environment.

Location – Wide range of feels and emotions. Tracks that would work well as themes for towns, forests, temples, and other locations.

Overworld – Exciting and open. Good for exploring the world map.

Tension – Scary and foreboding. Great for events at climactic moments in the story.

Victory – Triumphant. Tracks that work well for when you win in combat.

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Contact Me

Thank you so much for your interest in the RPG Music Essential music pack. I truly hope you enjoy using this music as much as I did creating it. If you have any questions or issues at all, please don't hesitate to contact me. I'd love to hear from you about your experience with the tracks, or talk about how we can work together to write custom music for your project!

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